# CODE OF CONDUCT

## WHAT IS A CODE OF CONDUCT?

The Code of Conduct outlines the expectations and behaviors of the Company's employees. The goal of this Code is to ensure that every employee of the Company is aware of acceptable conduct and ethical behavior.

## APPLICABILITY:

This Code applies to all employees of the Company in India, including trainees and temporary staff.

## CODE:

The Company is committed to conducting its business transparently by adopting the highest standards of professionalism, honesty, integrity, and ethical behavior. All employees are expected to strictly adhere to this Code of Conduct.

## GENERAL STANDARDS OF CONDUCT:

**Honesty and Fairness:** Employees are expected to perform their duties with honesty and fairness, avoiding conflicts of interest and ensuring all business dealings are conducted ethically.

All employees should be aware of all policies and procedures applicable to the Company and abide by them to the fullest extent. While policies and procedures could be questioned, they should happen through appropriate forums responsible for the review of policies and until any such change happens, no person should violate the existing policy/procedure.

## EQUAL OPPORTUNITIES:

- We recruit people solely on merit and reward people based on their performance and potential without discrimination on grounds of age, race, caste, ethnic origin, religion, political or other opinion, gender, sexual orientation, marital status, or disability/disease unrelated to the role.

- No employee will discriminate between others based on any of the above grounds or based on any other personal prejudices or biases.

**ENABLING WORK ENVIRONMENT:**

- The Company respects the rights and dignity of all employees. We aim to establish clear values and objectives so that all employees understand and are committed to the aims of the Company and see their roles within it. We will seek to create a challenging environment of empowerment and continuous learning, to recognize individual and team contributions, and to reward competitively, relative to performance.

- It is expected that all employees in the Company treat the people they interact with, both within and outside the Company, with respect and in a manner that their self-esteem and dignity are maintained at all times.

- All employees shall work in a collaborative manner towards the achievement of business goals, putting the interests of the team and the Company before their own. They will work in a manner that is open, honest, straightforward, and fair, respectful of the roles and views of others, and actively listening and dialoguing with teammates.

- Employees will freely share required information, learn from each other, help one another to develop and grow, and contribute towards making the experience of working for the Company an enjoyable one.

- The Company is committed to providing a work environment free of unlawful harassment. Sexual harassment and harassment based on age, race, religion, caste, ethnic origin, disability unrelated to the role, marital status, sexual orientation, pregnancy/childbirth, or any other basis is prohibited. No employee will indulge in or condone harassment of any kind. Our policy on sexual harassment spells out further details on this particular type of harassment.

**CONFLICT OF INTEREST:**

The term “conflict of interest” describes any circumstances that could cast doubt on our ability to act with total objectivity concerning the Company's interests.

- No employee will be involved in any arrangement or circumstances, including family or other personal relationships, which might discourage him/her from acting in the best interest of the Company.
- No employee or his/her family member will act as a broker or on behalf of a third party in transactions involving or potentially involving the Company.
- Employees or their family members will not have any financial interest in any outside enterprise that is currently doing business or seeks to do business with or is a competitor of the Company if the employee comes to know that the Company is doing business with any organization/individual with which he/she is directly or indirectly involved.
- An employee should not be the final decision maker for any business contract or arrangement with any organization wherein his/her relatives/close friends are employed in key positions. In the event an employee finds himself/herself in a position of having to decide on such a contract or arrangement, he/she should refrain from taking such a decision and refer the matter to his/her superior for taking a decision, clearly informing his/her superior of his/her relationship with key personnel in the other organization.
- An employee must declare that he/she is related to any other employee of the Company as soon as he/she discovers it, through a written letter/mail to the Head HR.
- Employees shall not exploit for their personal gain opportunities that are discovered through the use of corporate property, information, or position.
- No employee shall solicit or promote any personal/public cause or organization/ association during working hours.

**PAYMENT, GIFTS, AND ENTERTAINMENT:**

- The Company will not make any contribution of company funds, property, or services to a political party or religious organization, or a candidate for or holder of any Government office.
- No employee will offer any gifts, favors, or entertainment to others that are:
  i. Not consistent with customary business practice.
  ii. Excessive in value and/or could be construed as a bribe or pay-off in violation of applicable laws or ethical standards, such that public disclosure could

embarrass the Company or oneself. Employees should get the prior approval of the Business/Functional Head to incur any expenses towards entertainment.

iii. Business/Functional Heads are responsible for monitoring the incurred entertainment expense patterns of their employees to ensure that the amount is used judiciously. All expenditures that do not have the necessary documentation, bills, etc. will not be reimbursed. Entertainment expenditure on alcoholic drinks will be permitted only with the specific approval of the Business/Functional Head.

iv. Employees should not as a principle, accept gifts in kind or cash or enjoy any special privileges from any business associate. Complimentary gifts/Sweets may be accepted only on festive occasions if they serve the purpose of maintaining proper and good relationships with our regular business associates; however, the value of such complimentary gifts should not exceed Rs. 1000/- in value. Moreover, it is preferable that sweets, etc. if accepted on festive occasions are received only at the place of work and shared with colleagues

v. Employees should not accept offers to be entertained by an individual or organizations with whom the Company transacts business. Invitations to occasional lunches/dinners hosted by our business associates may be accepted, if it serves the purpose of enhancing the relationship, after informing the immediate superior. It is essential that in the event of an employee accepting complimentary gifts (up to the value specified) or attending an occasional lunch/dinner; there should be no scope for this to be construed as having influenced the judgment of the recipient.

vi. Employees will be reimbursed for outstation travel/local conveyance expenses incurred on account of official work as per policy of the Company. Employees should claim only expenses incurred and should not inflate/falsify expense claims even if these are within the prescribed limits for the individual. Under no circumstances shall personal expenses be reimbursed by the company.

**USE OF THE COMPANY'S ASSETS:**

- Protecting the Company's assets is a key responsibility of every employee. Care should be taken to ensure that assets are not misused, misappropriated, loaned to others, or sold or donated, or mortgaged, without appropriate authorization. Employees may not use Company assets for personal use, nor may they allow any

other person to use Company assets.

- Every employee is personally responsible for all Company funds over which he/she exercises control. Company funds must be used only for business purposes.
- Every employee must take reasonable steps to ensure that the Company receives good value for Company funds spent and must maintain accurate and timely records of expenditure.

**COMPLIANCE:**

- It is the Company's policy to comply fully in letter and spirit with all applicable laws, rules, and regulations. In case of ambiguity of the laws or their interpretation, legal advice should be sought.
- All required information shall be made accessible to the Company's auditors other authorized persons and government agencies. False or misleading entries, unrecorded funds or assets, or payments without appropriate supporting documentation and approval are strictly prohibited and violate Company policy and the Law.
- There shall be no willful omissions of any company transactions from the books and records, no advance income recognition, and no hidden bank accounts and funds. No employee in any way will cause the company's accounts or other records to not clearly describe and properly state the true nature and timing of a business activity or transaction.

**ENVIRONMENT, HEALTH AND SAFETY:**

Employees should carefully consider the potential impact of the company's activities, products, and services on human health, and the environment. They should take necessary measures, beyond meeting legal requirements, to mitigate this impact. In the course of carrying out their responsibilities, employees should ensure that their acts of commission and omission adversely affect the Environment.

**RELATIONS WITH CUSTOMERS:**

The Company recognizes that our customers are of paramount importance and the Company will prosper only to the extent that we meet and exceed the needs of our customers.

All employees must:

i. Recommend, products and/or services from the Company that best suits the customer's needs.
ii. Ensure that products and/or services supplied to customers meet the stated quantity and specifications.
iii. Endeavour to meet delivery commitments to customers and notify them well in advance if unable to do so due to unavoidable reasons.
iv. Respond promptly to all queries from customers.
v. Handle all customer complaints promptly and fairly.

**MEDIA POLICY:**

- Employees should refrain from interaction/communication with print and electronic media on topics that could impact the company's image.

- All statements to the media should be truthful and fair. Only authorized individuals within each business unit and division are permitted to communicate with the media on specific subjects. Employees should not selectively disclose nonpublic information to certain groups.

- Ensure the prior approval from customers, vendors, etc, is necessary if their references are made. Posting or discussing information concerning the Company's services or business on the Internet without the prior written consent of the Head of the Company /Business is prohibited.

- Advertising should not misrepresent the product and should not be likely to mislead consumers. All employees are required to protect the trademarks, brand names, and other proprietary material of the company and third parties. Disparaging competitors' products or services and making political or religious remarks in advertisements should be avoided.

**CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION:**

Please be mindful of the following guidelines:

- Employees should use any information obtained during work duties solely for its intended purpose and not for personal or third-party gain. Do not disclose confidential information without proper authorization.

- The Company has many kinds of business relationships with many companies and individuals. All employees should take special care in handling confidential information of our customers, potential customers, suppliers, potential suppliers, or any other third party with responsibility.

- As per the terms of the Employment Contract, all employees must dedicate their full-time attention to their responsibilities with the company. They should not serve as an employee, agent, director, partner, or consultant of any other business enterprise. Also, employees who resign from the services of the Company should not take up employment with a competitor for at least one year.

**ELECTRONIC RESOURCES USAGE:**

- Employees are required to use only licensed software and take backup of all important data. Uses that threaten the integrity of the system, and the privacy of others, or that are otherwise illegal, are hence forbidden.

- The Company reserves the right to access and monitor all messages and files on its system, as well as information regarding employee internet use when deemed necessary and appropriate.

- The electronic resources must be used in an effective, ethical and lawful manner. Users who receive or notice obscene or inappropriate messages are required to report them immediately to their immediate superior or the Human Resources Department. The Company will not be held responsible for any illegal actions of employees concerning the use of electronic resources.

## CHANGE LOG:

| Version | Date | Author | Section | Change Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1.0 | 15-05-2020 | HR | Overall | Release of the Code of Conduct for this financial year. |
| 1.1 | 13-08-2024 | HR/Balaji | Overall | Release of the Code of Conduct for this financial year. |

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